DATA DAY

MID-OHIO REGIONAL MORPC PLANNING COMMISSION

Data Day 2027 Champions: Ways to Help

Welcome, Champion

Data Day brings together Central Ohio's data creators, innovators, analysts, and end users to advance how our region uses data to improve the region. As a Data Day Champion, you help make that happen at a few key moments across the planning year, in the ways that fit you best.

A few things to know up front:

- **It's light and opt-in.** There's no standing committee and no monthly meetings. Each way to help is a specific, time-bound opportunity, and you choose which ones you take on.
- **You connect and amplify; MORPC handles the rest.** You might suggest a keynote, share the Call for Proposals, or open a door to a sponsor. MORPC staff handle the invitations, decisions, and logistics.
- **You'll always have what you need.** For every one below, we provide the templates, links, and talking points so it's genuinely quick.

Below are five ways to help.

1. Connect us with potential keynote speakers

What it is: Help us find keynote speakers who fit the 2027 theme and will draw a crowd. You're a scout and a connector: you surface names and open doors where you have a relationship.

What we'd ask of you:

- Suggest one to three keynote candidates (a name, their organization, and why they'd be a great fit).
- For anyone you know personally, offer to make a quick introduction to our staff lead, after checking that they're open to it.

When: August–October (suggestions are most useful by late September).
Time: About an hour, plus a short intro email if you make one.
What you'll have: The theme and a short list of what makes a strong Data Day keynote, a simple suggestion form, and an introduction template you can copy.

2. Share the Call for Session Proposals and recruit speakers

What it is: Help us fill the program with great breakout sessions by spreading the Call for Session Proposals (CFP) and personally encouraging strong potential presenters to submit.

What we'd ask of you:

- Share the CFP through your channels: email, LinkedIn, your organization's newsletter, etc.
- Personally encourage two or three people or teams you think would present well.

When: Late September through November 27, when proposals are due.
Time: An hour or two, spread across a few nudges.
What you'll have: The CFP link, a ready-made promo slide and social graphic with suggested copy, a short "why present at Data Day" blurb, and the key dates.

3. Help solicit sponsors

What it is: Help us reach organizations that might sponsor Data Day. You surface leads and make warm introductions; MORPC staff handle the package, the pricing, and the ask.

What we'd ask of you:

- Suggest organizations that might be a good fit (vendors, consultancies, civic-minded businesses).
- Make a quick introduction to our staff lead, after confirming the contact is interested.
- Pass along the sponsorship brochure to relevant people in your network.

When: September onward, with most introductions in September–November.
Time: As little as one introduction.
What you'll have: The sponsorship brochure, a one-line summary of the tiers and benefits, an introduction template, and our staff lead's contact.

4. Encourage registration

What it is: Once registration opens, help us fill the room by inviting your network and your colleagues.

What we'd ask of you:

- Share the registration link when it opens, and again at a few key moments (when the agenda publishes, two weeks out, and the final week).
- Personally invite colleagues, and encourage whole teams from your organization to come.
- Once the agenda is live, point people to specific sessions or keynotes you think they'd value.

When: November through late January, ramping up after the agenda publishes in early January.
Time: An hour or so, spread across a few shares.
What you'll have: The registration link, ready-to-use email and social copy with graphics for each moment, the published agenda, and the headline reasons to attend.

5. Take a day-of role

What it is: Help the event run smoothly. There are several roles to choose from: facilitating a breakout is the anchor role, and there are other ways to pitch in too.

What we'd ask of you (pick a role):

- **Session facilitator:** introduce the speaker, keep time, run Q&A, and help with any AV hiccups.
- **Workshop session assistant:** support the instructor during hands-on workshops: help participants follow along, troubleshoot, and keep things moving.
- **Greeter:** welcome attendees, help with check-in and name tags.
- **Social / photo:** capture and share moments throughout the day.

When: Roles are assigned in January; facilitators connect with their speaker in early February; everything happens on event day.
Time: A short prep touchpoint plus your time on event day.
What you'll have: Your assignment, a one-page facilitator cheat sheet (intro template, time cues, sample Q&A prompts, and who to call for AV), the run-of-show, speaker bios, pre-loaded slides, and a day-of contact list.

Ready to help?

You can take on as many or as few of these as you'd like. Let us know which interest you at **our sign-up form**, and we'll follow up with the details and timing for each.

Thank you for helping us make year five the best one yet.